

A Brilliant \$50,000,000/Month Shopify Niche Store

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Executive Summary

Anua, a Korean skincare brand generating ~\$500M/year across Shopify, Amazon, TikTok Shop, and retail, succeeds through radical simplicity, smart bundling, trend-surfing ingredients, and a lean ad strategy that prioritizes organic and creator content over heavy Meta spend.

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Brand Overview: Who Is Anua? 0:25

- Anua is a **Korean skincare brand** doing approximately **\$500 million per year** in revenue
 - Revenue is spread across Shopify, Amazon, TikTok Shop, and retail (not just one channel)
 - They also have a partnership with **Kendall Jenner**, signaling a strong focus on influencer relationships
- The host (Ari) runs a Meta ads agency (highest tier Meta agency partner) and his own e-commerce brand
 - He uses these breakdowns as a learning exercise and to share value with his audience
- Korean skincare brands approach e-commerce differently than typical US brands — this video explores what that means in practice

Traffic & Ad Volume: The Minimal Meta Approach 0:52

- Anua's Shopify store receives approximately **368,000 monthly visitors**
 - The vast majority of this traffic is **organic** — SEO and spillover from social platforms
 - They are not relying on paid Meta traffic to drive Shopify visits
- They run only **110 active ads globally** across all of Meta at any given time
 - For context, some top US brands run **6,000+ active ads** simultaneously

- 110 ads is described as "nothing" relative to hyper-scaling US brands
- This raises an open question: are US brands overspending on Meta?
 - Ari acknowledges he's a Meta proponent but notes Anua is doing \$500M/year profitably with minimal Meta spend
 - He suspects Anua's profits may be higher than many US brands at similar scale, precisely because they don't blow budgets on Meta
 - Instead, Anua appears to invest heavily in **TikTok creators** and **Amazon**

Shopify Store Strategy: Simplicity & Social Proof 1:48

- Their landing pages are described as **extremely simple** — almost strikingly so
 - The page structure is essentially: product image/set → reviews → done
 - Product benefits and details are hidden under **collapsible carousels** — available if you want them, not forced on you
 - Philosophy: if you want to dig deeper, you can; if you just want to buy, you can do that immediately
- The design isn't particularly polished or premium-looking by Ari's assessment
 - "This looks sort of ugly to me even" — yet it converts extremely well
 - Key insight: **easy to understand beats aesthetically impressive**
- Heavy reliance on **reviews** as the primary persuasion mechanism
 - No elaborate copywriting needed when social proof does the heavy lifting
- They also include a **countdown timer** at the top of key pages to create urgency

Bundle Bestsellers: Boosting Average Order Value 2:13

- Their **#1 bestseller is a set** — a bundle of multiple individual products sold as one product listing
 - This is a deliberate strategy to raise average order value (AOV) on a low-AOV product catalog
- The framework Ari recommends based on this:
 - If you sell individual products at ~\$20 each, build a bundle product priced at ~\$120
 - That bundle = 6–7 of your products combined, with one included free as a limited-time offer
 - This lets you continuously create **new, exciting offers** that incentivize immediate purchase
- Benefits of this approach:
 - Higher AOV without changing the underlying product
 - "Free gift" framing creates perceived value and urgency
 - Flexibility to rotate offers and keep the store feeling fresh
- Ari notes this strategy works even if the store design looks basic — simplicity + strong offer = conversions

The single biggest tactical takeaway: bundle your low-AOV products into a set, offer one free, and you

instantly have a high-converting flagship SKU.



Trend-Surfing Ingredients: Azelaic Acid & Unique Mechanisms 3:35

- What inspired this video: Ari noticed **azelaic acid** as a surging trend in skincare search data
 - **1.2 million monthly searches** for azelaic acid — described as "absolutely booming"
 - Demand is growing rapidly and Anua has already capitalized on it
- Anua's strategy: **continuously hop on the latest skincare ingredient waves**
 - Keeps them relevant in a fast-moving category
 - Lets them capitalize on ingredients that have genuine efficacy (azelaic acid is backed by research for acne/breakouts)
- How they differentiate in crowded markets — the **unique mechanism** approach:
 - Don't just sell the trending ingredient alone; combine it with something else
 - Example 1: Instead of just a collagen bar, they sell **collagen + retinol**
 - Example 2: Instead of just azelaic acid, they sell **azelaic acid + cica** (a calming/healing ingredient)
 - This creates a new, distinct product out of a highly competitive but high-demand category
- This pattern is consistent across Korean skincare brands broadly — similar product categories, but with slight unique mechanisms that differentiate each brand



Meta Ad Breakdown: What's Actually Running 5:23

- Ads are sorted by most impressions (top-performing first) in Meta's Ad Library
- One of their **top ads links to Amazon** — they have Amazon buy buttons on their Shopify site
 - Noteworthy: they're comfortable sending paid traffic directly to Amazon from Meta
- Another top ad uses a bold direct-response hook: **"Sorry, we lowered the price"**
 - Ari describes this as "super off-brand" and not premium-feeling — but it works
 - Drives users to a **bestsellers page** where they can browse top products
 - Paired with a countdown timer for urgency
 - Offer featured: **5 free gifts** with purchase — a very aggressive value proposition
- Key insight: a great offer makes ads work better, almost regardless of creative polish
 - "If your offer is better, your ads are simply going to work better"
- How to use Meta Ad Library (quick tutorial mentioned):
 - Go to Meta Ad Library
 - Search a brand's **domain name**
 - Select "search this exact phrase"
 - View all currently active ads for that brand — free, no login required

TikTok Creator Content as Meta Ads 6:37

- A large portion of Anua's Meta ads are **repurposed TikTok videos** — partnership/creator ads
- Example ad breakdown (one of their top performers):
 - Hook: "\$300 for acne treatments — nah, we can do it for \$22"
 - Creator poses as a pharmacist explaining the acne cycle: prevent → treat → fade
 - Problem framing: most products only do one of the three steps, requiring multiple purchases
 - Solution: Anua's product handles all three for \$22
 - Ari's read: highly **solution-aware** ad — assumes the viewer has already heard of expensive alternatives
 - He found it compelling enough to want to watch the entire thing
- These are essentially **UGC (user-generated content) / creator ads** that double as organic TikTok content
- Tool mentioned for scaling creator content: **Tribe**
 - Ari uses it for his own brand
 - Helps collect UGC content at a fraction of the cost of managing creators manually
 - Described as making creator scaling "a little bit easier" — direct creator management is hard to scale
 - Link mentioned as available in video description

Key Takeaways & Channel Distribution 8:22

- Anua's success comes from a **multi-channel approach**, not Meta-first dominance:
 - Shopify (organic traffic, ~368K/month)
 - Amazon (likely dominant; probably run heavy Amazon ads)
 - TikTok Shop (significant creator investment)
 - Retail (major physical presence)
 - Influencer (Kendall Jenner partnership; strong influencer culture)
- They likely achieve **higher profit margins** than comparable US brands because:
 - They don't blow budgets on Meta ad spend
 - They invest in channels (Amazon, TikTok creators) that may have better returns for their product type
- Actionable lessons summarized:
 - Keep landing pages **simple** — reviews + product, minimal friction
 - Build **bundle products** to raise AOV on low-price catalogs
 - **Hop on trending ingredients** early and add a unique mechanism to differentiate
 - A **bold offer** (free gifts, price drops) outperforms polished creative
 - Repurpose **TikTok creator content** as Meta ads — it works and it's cost-efficient
 - Don't over-index on Meta; consider whether Amazon and TikTok might be better primary channels for your category
- Open question Ari leaves unanswered: Should Anua be running more Meta ads? Could they grow even faster with 6,000 active ads like top US brands? Unknown — but their current approach is clearly working.